

Step 1 — Verify the Recipient (and Sender) Email in SES

1. Open the AWS Console and go to Simple Email Service (SES).
2. Confirm the region in the top-right corner (e.g. Asia Pacific (Mumbai)).
3. In the left sidebar, go to Configuration → Identities → Create identity.
4. Choose Identity type: Email address, enter the address to verify, then click Create identity.
5. Open that inbox and click the verification link in the email from Amazon Web Services.
6. Refresh the Identities page — status should change to Verified.

Note: While the SES account is in Sandbox mode (the default for new accounts), both the sender and recipient addresses used in the script must be verified identities. Using the same verified address for both sender and recipient is a valid way to test.

Step 2 — Get SMTP Credentials from the SES Console

7. In the SES console, go to Configuration → SMTP settings.
8. Under IAM SMTP credentials, click Create IAM credentials.
9. This creates a dedicated IAM user and generates SMTP credentials (different from normal AWS access keys).
10. Copy or download the SMTP Username and SMTP Password — the password is shown only once.

The SMTP endpoint follows the pattern email-smtp.<region>.amazonaws.com. For the Asia Pacific (Mumbai) region, this is:

```
email-smtp.ap-south-1.amazonaws.com
```

Step 3 — Install PHP and Dependencies on the Instance

Connect to the instance (SSH or EC2 Instance Connect), then install PHP:

```
sudo yum update -y
sudo yum install -y php php-cli
php -v
```

Install Composer (used to pull in the PHPMailer library):

```
curl -sS https://getcomposer.org/installer -o composer-setup.php
php composer-setup.php
sudo mv composer.phar /usr/local/bin/composer
composer --version
```

Create a project folder and require PHPMailer. If Composer reports a missing zip extension, install unzip first.

```
sudo yum install -y unzip
mkdir ~/ses-mail && cd ~/ses-mail
composer require phpmailer/phpmailer
```

Step 4 — Create and Run the PHP Script

Create send_mail.php in the project folder:

```
cat > send_mail.php << 'EOF'
<?php
use PHPMailer\PHPMailer\PHPMailer;
```

```

use PHPMailer\PHPMailer\SMTP;
use PHPMailer\PHPMailer\Exception;

require 'vendor/autoload.php';

$mail = new PHPMailer(true);

try {
    $mail->isSMTP();
    $mail->Host      = 'email-smtp.ap-south-1.amazonaws.com';
    $mail->SMTPAuth  = true;
    $mail->Username  = 'AKIASSMSW4VCUNLBH2QQ';
    $mail->Password  = 'BI1EyH2HvkG0oD4wFaDRZjAGFV+QVetM+U4jk8wI4gKJ';
    $mail->SMTPSecure = PHPMailer::ENCRYPTION_STARTTLS;
    $mail->Port      = 587;

    $mail->setFrom('your-verified-sender@example.com', 'Your Name');
    $mail->addAddress('recipient-verified@example.com', 'Recipient Name');

    $mail->isHTML(true);
    $mail->Subject = 'Test Email via AWS SES';
    $mail->Body    = '<h1>Hello!</h1><p>This is a test email sent using AWS SES and
PHP.</p>';
    $mail->AltBody = 'Hello! This is a test email sent using AWS SES and PHP.';

    $mail->send();
    echo "Message has been sent successfully";
} catch (Exception $e) {
    echo "Message could not be sent. Mailer Error: {$mail->ErrorInfo}";
}

EOF

```

Edit the file to insert the real SMTP username/password and the verified email address(es), then run it:

```
php send_mail.php
```

A successful run prints: "Message has been sent successfully". This confirms SES accepted the message for delivery — it does not by itself confirm the message reached the inbox.

Step 5 — Verify Delivery

11. Check the recipient inbox, including the Spam/Junk folder.
12. In Gmail, search from:(amazonses.com) or the exact subject line to catch messages filtered into Spam, Promotions, or All Mail.
13. In the SES console, go to Reputation metrics (or Account dashboard) to confirm the send was logged, and check the bounce rate and complaint rate — both should read 0.00% and status Healthy for a normal successful send.
14. Allow a few minutes for first-time delivery from a brand-new sending identity, since receiving providers are often more cautious with unfamiliar senders.

OUTPUT:

